

Marking rubric for project proposal report

Intended audience: The Project proposal report assignment should now contain considerable detail about your project. You need to provide confidence to the assessment panel that you have a good chance of completing the project and “*you know what you are doing*”! Assume that the panel does not know much about your project. (In a real-life situation, financial considerations would be crucial, but as a student project here, you do not have to discuss financial considerations).

Introduction (10)	The Introduction briefly: • Introduces the project and team. • Sets the background, context, problem or opportunity for the project. • Outlines the expected project outcome. • Introduces the report, outlines its structure and provides a clear overview of each section.
HD 80-100	• Professionally written, including all of the above. • Provides a simple, clear and accurate indication of what to expect in the report.
D 70 - <80	• Well written, including most of the above. • Provides a somewhat simple, mostly clear and/or mostly true indication of what to expect in the report.
C 60 - <70	• Readable, including some of the above. • Provides a somewhat simple, not always clear and/or ambiguous indication of what to expect in the report.
P 50 - <60	• Contains errors or is poorly worded, includes perhaps a half of what is required, and provides a basic coverage of what to expect in the report.
N <50	• Fails to meet requirements with regard to writing quality and/or content. Some marks will be allocated for the contents.

Background material, literature review (15)	• The literature review provides the background for the project in detail. • Cites, discusses and synthesises the relevant points from 15 references per team summarised in a few paragraphs that address proposed components of the project (e.g. project management processes and techniques, project topic, likely use-cases, user interface design, data analysis technique, user testing etc.). • Includes grey literature, academic literature, software, hardware (if relevant). • Covers project management methodologies, evidence of a gap/opportunity for the project, existing “competing” tools addressing the main project goals. • References cited and appear in a Bibliography in APA or IEEE format.
--	--

Faculty of Information Technology

FIT3161 Computer Science Project Part 1

FIT3163 Data Science Project Part 1

FIT3188 Cyber Security Project Part 1

HD 80-100 Exceptional, comprehensive, and critical engagement with the literature.	• Integrates 15+ highly relevant and diverse sources, including both academic and grey literature, and any relevant software/hardware tools. • Demonstrates a deep critical analysis of project management methodologies, existing gaps, and competing tools, clearly linking them to the project aims. • Flawless referencing in APA or IEEE format with a logically structured, well-written review that shows original insight and synthesis.
D 70 - <80 Strong, well-organized review, insightful discussion and minor gaps.	• Cites a sufficient range of relevant sources (15+ per team) with solid inclusion of multiple literature types (academic and grey). • Shows good understanding and some critical evaluation of methodologies, project gaps, and existing tools. • Minor referencing or structural issues, but arguments remain clear, coherent, and well-supported.
C 60 - <70 Competent review showing understanding and some analysis but limited depth.	• Meets the minimum source requirement, though may rely too heavily on one literature type or omit some relevant categories (e.g., grey or technical sources). • Demonstrates basic discussion of methodologies, gaps, and competing tools, but analysis is mostly descriptive rather than critical. • Some referencing or clarity issues, but overall organization and purpose are evident.
P 50 - <60 Adequate but underdeveloped review showing limited engagement.	• Insufficient depth or variety of sources; may meet numerical requirements but lack clear relevance or diversity. • Discussion of methodologies and existing tools is superficial or incomplete, with limited connection to the project context. • Frequent referencing or formatting errors; writing may be unclear or poorly organized.
N <50 Inadequate review showing minimal understanding or effort.	• Too few or irrelevant sources, lacking academic rigor and diversity (missing key references or types of literature). • Little to no analysis of project management approaches, gaps, or competing tools; fails to demonstrate understanding of the topic. • Major referencing, structure, or clarity problems, making the review difficult to follow or academically unacceptable.

Project Management Plan (50)	The Project Management Plan describes <i>your</i> plan to deliver <i>your</i> project It includes: • Scope statement • Requirements discussion and Requirement Traceability Matrix • Team organisation and roles • Project management process • Schedule • Resources
--	--

HD 80-100 Outstanding, comprehensive, and realistic Project Management Plan demonstrating exceptional planning and professionalism.	● Scope: Detailed scope statement showing in-scope and out-of-scope items. The scope statement will also show some consideration for high and low-priority items. ● Requirements: Detailed explanation of extensive list of requirement specifications including a good discussion of how requirements are obtained and an extensive Requirement Traceability Matrix. Includes detailed product acceptance criteria. ● Organisation: Detailed explanation and justification of PM methodology used (Agile or predictive, or else?) and tools used. ● Detailed description and discussion of team organisation as roles and responsibilities of team members. ● Management Process: Comprehensive discussion of Risk management and extensive Risk Register covering PM and Technical risk relating to Project execution. Comprehensive Communication plan (team and other stakeholders). ● Schedule: detailed schedule as Gantt Chart showing planning of major phases, task dependencies and milestones. ● Resources: A detailed list of technical and human resources, showing a clear understanding of resource usage in overall project execution.
D 70 - <80 Strong, well-structured plan showing solid understanding and application of project management practices.	● Scope: Good scope statement showing in-scope and out-of-scope items. Scope statement will also show some consideration for high and low priority items. ● Requirements: Explanation of good list of requirements, including brief discussion of how requirements are obtained, and good Requirement Traceability Matrix and acceptance criteria. ● Organisation: Good explanation and justification of PM methodology used (Agile or predictive, or else?) and tools used. ● Good description and discussion of team organisation as roles and responsibilities of team members. ● Management Process: Good discussion of Risk management and extensive Risk Register covering PM and Technical risk relating to Project execution. Good communication plan (team and other stakeholders). ● Schedule: Good schedule as Gantt Chart showing planning of major phases, task dependencies and milestones ● Resources: A good list of technical and human resources, showing a clear understanding of resource usage in overall project execution.
C 60 - <70 Competent plan showing understanding of core project management elements but limited depth or	● Scope: Reasonable scope statement showing in-scope and out-of-scope items. Scope statement will also show some consideration for high and low priority items. ● Requirements: Explanation of requirement specification including brief discussion of how requirements are obtained. And includes an RTM. ● Organisation: Reasonable explanation and justification of PM methodology used (Agile or predictive, or else?) and, tools used. ● Reasonable description and discussion of team organisation as roles and responsibilities of team members.

consistency.	● Management Process: Reasonable discussion of Risk management and extensive Risk Register covering PM and Technical risk relating to Project execution. Reasonable communication plan (team and other stakeholders). ● Schedule: Reasonable schedule as Gantt Chart showing planning of major phases, task dependencies and milestones. ● Resources: A Reasonable list of technical and human resources, showing a clear understanding of resource usage in overall project execution.
P 50 - <60 Adequate but underdeveloped plan demonstrating limited engagement with project management principles.	● Scope: Some scope statement showing in-scope. ● Requirements: Explanation of requirement specification including a brief discussion of how requirements are obtained with a risk register showing minimal understanding of requirements and requirement traceability matrix. ● Organisation: Minimal description of PM methodology. ● Management Process: Unclear or poor discussion of Risk management relating to Project execution. Poor communication plan. ● Schedule: Unclear schedule as Gantt Chart showing minimal planning of major phases, task dependencies and milestones. ● Resources: Incomplete list of technical and human resources, showing minimal understanding of resource usage in overall project execution.
N <50 Incomplete or incoherent plan demonstrating minimal understanding of project management fundamentals.	● Major components missing or seriously inadequate, preventing understanding of how the project will be managed or delivered. ● Little or no evidence of understanding project management practices, scheduling, or resource allocation. ● Poorly organized, unclear, or inconsistent, with unrealistic or missing details that undermine credibility. ● Some marks may be awarded for content.

Proposed Methodology (10)	The Methodology section should provide sufficient detail to enable another developer or team to follow the same steps and processes as your team to produce the same results. It should fully describe: ● Required software, utilities, tools to develop your project. ● Data collection, management and processing steps that you anticipate will be necessary. ● Software development steps that you anticipate undertaking.
HD 80-100 Demonstrates exceptional	● Provides a complete and unambiguous description of all required software, tools, and utilities, including libraries, programming languages, and data management requirements. ● Outlines a clear, detailed, and logical step-by-step methodology that

Faculty of Information Technology**FIT3161 Computer Science Project Part 1****FIT3163 Data Science Project Part 1****FIT3188 Cyber Security Project Part 1**

understanding and attention to detail; methodology is comprehensive, precise, and fully replicable.	covers all stages of development and processing. • Offers thorough justification for all decisions, enabling another developer to replicate results exactly.
D 70 - <80 Demonstrates strong understanding and organisation; methodology is clear, detailed, and largely replicable with minor clarifications needed.	• Provides a clear and mostly complete description of software, tools, and utilities, with only minor omissions or ambiguities. • Presents a logical and detailed workflow, describing most development and data steps clearly. • Gives sound justification for most decisions, allowing replication with minimal additional clarification.
C 60 - <70 Demonstrates competent understanding; methodology is adequate but lacks depth, precision, or full justification.	• Provides a reasonable description of most required software and tools, though some important details are missing. • Outlines key development and data management steps, but lacks clarity or depth in certain areas. • Gives partial justification of decisions; replication would require assumptions or clarifications.
P 50 - <60 Demonstrates basic understanding; methodology is incomplete or loosely structured, with limited clarity or justification.	• Provides a basic or incomplete list of software and tools, omitting several key components or steps. • Shows limited structure or detail in describing development and data processes. • Offers minimal or unclear justification for decisions; replication would be difficult without further information.
N <50 Demonstrates poor or insufficient understanding; methodology is unclear, incomplete, or non-replicable.	• Fails to provide clear or accurate details about required software, tools, or processes. • Displays unclear, inconsistent, or illogical sequencing of development and data steps. • Shows little to no justification or understanding of methodology; replication is not possible. • Some marks may be awarded for content.

Conclusion (5)	The conclusion completes the report and summarises its key points.
-----------------------	--

Faculty of Information Technology**FIT3161 Computer Science Project Part 1****FIT3163 Data Science Project Part 1****FIT3188 Cyber Security Project Part 1**

HD 80-100	Clearly and succinctly written, recaps all major points. Clearly relates to the project, project management, methodology etc. Logical and coherent.
D 70 - <80	Clearly and succinctly written, recaps the points presented earlier. Relates well to the project, project management, methodology etc. Logical and coherent.
C 60 - <70	Well written, recapping most of the points presented earlier. Relates to most of the project ideas, project management, methodology etc. Logical and coherent.
P 50 - <60	This shows an attempt to recap most of the points presented earlier. Relates somewhat to the project, project management, methodology etc. Logical and coherent.
N <50	An inadequate attempt that misses many key points and/or is poorly written. Some marks may be awarded for content.

Style & Presentation (5) References (5)	
HD 80 - 100 Exceptionally professional and polished presentation that meets or exceeds all academic and formatting standards.	● Consistently excellent formatting including considered use of fonts, indentation, line and paragraph spacing, and white space. ● Section headings and subheadings are consistently numbered, correctly aligned with the Table of Contents, and used in cross referencing appropriately between document sections. ● Excellent English expression, clearly written, easy to follow, correct spelling and grammar. ● Diagrams are clear, labelled, numbered and referred to correctly in the main text. ● The front cover sheet includes all required information. ● References are provided in the correct format and are properly cited within the document.
D 70 - <80 Strong, well-presented report with minor inconsistencies that do not detract from readability or professionalism.	● Very good formatting and visual presentation; minor inconsistencies in spacing, font size, or alignment. ● Headings and numbering are mostly correct, well applied and align with the Table of Contents; cross-references generally used appropriately. ● Very good English expression; clear and mostly fluent with only occasional minor grammar or spelling errors. ● Diagrams are clear and labelled but may have minor visual issues. ● Front cover includes all required information with only minor formatting inconsistencies.

Faculty of Information Technology

FIT3161 Computer Science Project Part 1

FIT3163 Data Science Project Part 1

FIT3188 Cyber Security Project Part 1

	● References are correctly formatted with minor citation or formatting errors.
C 60 - <70 Competently presented report showing sound effort but some inconsistency or lack of refinement.	● Adequate formatting, though inconsistencies in spacing, font use, or layout are evident. ● Headings and numbering are present but occasionally inconsistent with the Table of Contents; cross-referencing used irregularly. ● Writing is generally clear, though contains several minor grammar or spelling errors and occasional awkward phrasing. ● Diagrams are included and labelled but may be inconsistently formatted or not referred to clearly in text. They may be slightly unclear. ● Front cover includes most required information, but layout or detail may be inconsistent. ● References are mostly accurate but contain several formatting or citation inconsistencies.
P 50 - <60 Adequate presentation with frequent inconsistencies or basic errors that limit clarity or professionalism.	● Formatting is inconsistent or poorly applied; spacing, font use, or alignment issues are common. ● Headings and numbering partially implemented or inaccurate; Table of Contents misaligned or incomplete; cross-referencing rarely used. ● Writing is understandable but contains frequent grammar and spelling errors; structure may hinder readability. ● Diagrams are present but poorly labelled, unclear, or not referenced correctly. ● Front cover is missing some required information or incorrectly formatted. ● References are present but poorly formatted, incomplete, or inconsistently cited.
N <50 Poorly presented report that lacks clarity, consistency, or adherence to academic standards.	● Formatting is disorganized or absent; little evidence of consistent design or layout consideration. ● Headings and numbering missing or incorrect; Table of Contents absent or inaccurate; no cross-referencing. ● Writing is unclear, frequently incorrect, or difficult to follow due to numerous language and grammar errors. ● Diagrams missing, unreadable, unclear or unlabelled; not referenced in text. ● Front cover missing or lacking most required details. ● References largely missing, incorrect, or not cited in the text.